

Word family: **clash / clashes / clashed / clashing / clashingly / clash of personalities / clash of interests**

Base word: clash

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **clash** (n.) — 衝突；不和；爭執；對立；碰撞聲；不協調

* **clash** (v.) — 衝突；發生爭執；互相抵觸；不協調；相撞發出聲響

* **clashing** (adj./participle) — 衝突的；互相不協調的

* **clashingly** (adv.) — 不協調地；衝突地（較少見）

Major useful extensions:

clash with someone, clash over something, clash on something, clash about something, clash with another group, personalities clash, views clash, interests clash, priorities clash, values clash, cultures clash, schedules clash, dates clash, appointments clash, colours clash, styles clash, patterns clash, clash violently, clash repeatedly, clash openly, a clash between A and B, personality clash, clash of personalities, clash of opinions, clash of views, clash of values, clash of interests, clash of priorities, cultural clash, generational clash, ideological clash, armed clash, violent clash, street clash, border clash, clash with police, clash of cymbals, metallic clash, clash of swords, fixture clash, scheduling clash, date clash, colour clash, style clash, clash head-on, avoid a clash, prevent a clash, lead to a clash.

Meaning in this passage

> Nevertheless, personality **clashes** need not destroy cooperation.

Here, **clashes** means:

serious friction or conflict caused by incompatible personalities, habits, temperaments, or ways of behaving — 性格衝突；個性不合

The writer means that two people may have very different ways of:

- * speaking,
- * making decisions,
- * handling pressure,
- * giving feedback,
- * working at speed,
- * dealing with disagreement.

These differences may create repeated tension.

****中文翻譯：****

然而，****性格衝突 / 個性不合****並不一定會破壞合作。

So here:

**personality clash = 兩個或以上的人因性格、處事方式或溝通風格不合而產生的衝突**

A. CLASH = CONFLICT BETWEEN PEOPLE

1. **clash = serious disagreement or conflict — 衝突；不和**

This is the core figurative sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Personality ****clashes**** need not destroy cooperation.

****性格衝突****不一定會破壞合作。

Practice 2

> The two managers had several ****clashes**** over strategy.

兩名經理曾因策略問題發生數次****衝突****。

Practice 3

> Poor communication can turn small disagreements into serious clashes.

溝通不良可能把小分歧變成嚴重****衝突****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clash = 兩方因立場、性格、利益或做法不同而發生的明顯衝突****

2. **clash with someone — 與某人發生衝突**

Practice 1

> She often ****clashes with her manager****.

她經常****與經理發生衝突****。

Practice 2

> He clashed with several colleagues during the project.

他在項目期間**與數名同事發生爭執**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clash with someone = 與某人因意見、性格或利益不同而發生強烈分歧****

3. ****clash over something — 因某事發生衝突****

A very common pattern.

Practice 1

> The departments ****clashed over the deadline****.

各部門因截止日期問題**發生衝突**。

Practice 2

> Managers clashed over how resources should be allocated.

管理人員因資源如何分配而**發生爭執**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clash over X = 因 X 的處理方式、立場或決定不同而發生衝突****

4. ****clash on/about something — 就某事意見衝突****

Possible, though ****clash over**** is especially common.

Practice 1

> The two sides ****clashed on several issues****.

雙方在數個問題上**意見衝突**。

Practice 2

> They clashed about how quickly the change should be introduced.

他們就改變應多快推行而**發生爭執**。

5. **clash repeatedly — 反覆發生衝突**

Practice 1

> The two team leaders **clashed repeatedly**.

兩名團隊領袖**多次發生衝突**。

Practice 2

> Employees who clash repeatedly may need mediation.

經常**發生衝突**的員工可能需要調解。

6. **clash openly — 公開衝突**

Practice 1

> The managers **clashed openly** during the meeting.

兩名經理在會議上**公開發生衝突**。

Practice 2

> Senior staff rarely clash openly in front of clients.

高級員工很少在客戶面前**公開爭執**。

B. PERSONALITY CLASH

7. **personality clash — 性格衝突；個性不合**

This is the exact expression in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Personality **clashes** need not destroy cooperation.

****性格衝突**不一定會破壞合作。**

Practice 2

> Their disagreement was partly a ****personality clash****.

他們的分歧部分源於****性格不合****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personality clash = 因性格、習慣、溝通方式或處事風格不合而造成的持續摩擦****

8. ****clash of personalities — 性格衝突****

A full noun phrase equivalent.

Practice 1

> There was a clear ****clash of personalities**** between the two managers.

兩名經理之間有明顯的****性格衝突****。

Practice 2

> The problem was not technical but a clash of personalities.

問題並非技術問題，而是****個性不合****。

9. ****personalities clash — 性格不合****

Practice 1

> Their ****personalities clash****.

他們的****性格不合****。

Practice 2

> Strong personalities sometimes clash under pressure.

性格強勢的人在壓力下有時會****互相衝突****。

C. CLASH OF OPINIONS / VIEWS

10. **clash of opinions — 意見衝突**

Practice 1

> The meeting revealed a **clash of opinions**.

會議暴露出**意見衝突**。

Practice 2

> A clash of opinions does not have to become personal.

意見分歧不一定要演變成人身衝突。

11. **views clash — 觀點衝突**

Practice 1

> Their **views clashed** on the issue.

他們在這個問題上的**觀點互相衝突**。

Practice 2

> Different professional perspectives can clash.

不同專業角度可能會**互相抵觸**。

12. **clash of views — 觀點衝突**

Practice 1

> The debate became a **clash of views**.

辯論變成一場**觀點之爭**。

Practice 2

> The clash of views was handled respectfully.

這場**觀點衝突**被以尊重的方式處理。

D. CLASH OF VALUES

13. **values clash — 價值觀衝突**

Practice 1

> Their **values clash** on questions of risk and responsibility.

他們在風險與責任問題上的**價值觀互有衝突**。

Practice 2

> Workplace conflict may occur when personal and organisational values clash.

當個人價值觀和組織價值觀**不一致**時，可能出現職場衝突。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****values clash = 兩套價值觀對甚麼重要、正確或應該做有不同甚至互不相容的看法****

14. **clash of values — 價值觀衝突**

Practice 1

> The dispute reflected a deeper **clash of values**.

這場爭議反映更深層的**價值觀衝突**。

Practice 2

> A clash of values can be harder to resolve than a factual disagreement.

****價值觀衝突**可能比事實上的分歧更難解決。**

E. CLASH OF INTERESTS

15. **interests clash — 利益衝突**

Practice 1

> The interests of the two departments sometimes **clash**.

兩個部門的利益有時會**發生衝突**。

Practice 2

> Individual interests may clash with team objectives.

個人利益可能與團隊目標**互相衝突**。

16. **clash of interests** — 利益衝突

Practice 1

> The disagreement involved a **clash of interests**.

分歧涉及**利益衝突**。

Practice 2

> A clash of interests can make compromise difficult.

利益衝突可能令妥協變得困難。

Important note: **clash of interests vs conflict of interest**

These are not exactly the same.

clash of interests

two parties genuinely want incompatible things.

conflict of interest

a person's duties may be improperly influenced by a competing personal interest.

Example:

> Marketing wants speed; compliance wants caution.

> = possible **clash of interests/priorities**

> A manager awards a contract to their own company.

> = **conflict of interest**

Very important distinction.

F. CLASH OF PRIORITIES

17. **priorities clash — 優先事項互相衝突**

Highly relevant to this passage.

Practice 1

> The departments' **priorities clashed**.

各部門的**優先事項互相衝突**。

Practice 2

> Speed and caution can clash when deadlines are tight.

當截止日期緊迫時，速度和謹慎可能**互相抵觸**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****priorities clash = 不同人或部門認為最重要的事情不能同時完全兼顧****

18. **clash of priorities — 優先事項衝突**

Practice 1

> The delay resulted from a **clash of priorities**.

延誤源於**優先事項衝突**。

Practice 2

> Good leadership can reconcile a clash of priorities.

良好領導可以協調**不同優先事項之間的矛盾**。

G. CLASH OF GOALS / OBJECTIVES

19. **goals clash — 目標互相衝突**

Practice 1

> Individual goals can **clash with team goals**.

個人目標可能與團隊目標**互相衝突**。

Practice 2

> The departments clashed because their immediate goals differed.

各部門因短期目標不同而**產生衝突**。

20. **clashing objectives — 互相衝突的目標**

Practice 1

> The project suffered from **clashing objectives**.

項目因**目標互相衝突**而受影響。

Practice 2

> Managers need to identify clashing objectives early.

管理人員需要及早識別**相互矛盾的目標**。

H. CULTURAL CLASH

21. **cultural clash — 文化衝突**

Practice 1

> The merger created a **cultural clash** between the two companies.

合併令兩家公司之間出現**企業文化衝突**。

Practice 2

> Different communication styles may create cultural clashes.

不同溝通方式可能造成**文化衝突**。

MCQ-ready definition:

cultural clash = 不同文化中的價值、習慣或行為方式互不相容而產生的摩擦

22. **cultures clash — 文化發生衝突**

Practice 1

> Problems can arise when **workplace cultures clash**.

當不同**職場文化互相衝突**時，可能出現問題。

Practice 2

> The teams needed time to adapt when their cultures clashed.

兩個團隊的文化**發生衝突**時，需要時間適應。

I. GENERATIONAL CLASH

23. **generational clash — 世代衝突**

Practice 1

> Different expectations about work can produce a **generational clash**.

不同世代對工作的期望可能造成**世代衝突**。

Practice 2

> The issue was presented as a clash between generations.

這個問題被形容為**世代之間的衝突**。

24. **generations clash — 世代之間發生衝突**

Practice 1

> Generations sometimes clash over communication styles.

不同世代有時會因溝通方式而**產生摩擦**。

Practice 2

> Generational differences need not lead to open clashes.

世代差異不一定會導致公開**衝突**。

J. CLASH = PHYSICAL FIGHT / VIOLENT CONFRONTATION

25. **clash = violent confrontation between groups — 衝突；衝突事件**

A major news/general sense.

Practice 1

> Several people were injured in **clashes**.

數人在**衝突中**受傷。

Practice 2

> Violent clashes broke out between the two groups.

兩個群體之間爆發**暴力衝突**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clash = 兩個群體直接對抗，可能涉及暴力的衝突事件****

26. **clash with police — 與警方發生衝突**

Practice 1

> Protesters **clashed with police**.

示威者**與警方發生衝突**。

Practice 2

> Several people were arrested after clashes with police.

數人在**與警方衝突**後被捕。

27. **violent clash — 暴力衝突**

Practice 1

> A **violent clash** occurred outside the stadium.

球場外發生了一場**暴力衝突**。

Practice 2

> The demonstration ended in violent clashes.

示威最後演變成**暴力衝突**。

28. **armed clash — 武裝衝突**

Practice 1

> An **armed clash** occurred near the border.

邊境附近發生了一次**武裝衝突**。

Practice 2

> Local residents fled after armed clashes.

居民在**武裝衝突**後逃離。

29. **border clash — 邊境衝突**

Practice 1

> The incident developed into a **border clash**.

事件演變成一次**邊境衝突**。

Practice 2

> Several border clashes were reported.

據報發生了數次**邊境衝突**。

30. **street clashes — 街頭衝突**

Practice 1

> The unrest led to **street clashes**.

騷亂導致**街頭衝突**。

Practice 2

> Police tried to prevent further street clashes.

警方試圖防止更多**街頭衝突**。

K. CLASH = STRIKE TOGETHER WITH A LOUD SOUND

31. **clash = strike together noisily — 相撞並發出鏗鏘聲**

A completely different physical/sound sense.

Practice 1

> The metal gates **clashed together**.

金屬閘門互相撞擊，發出**鏗鏘聲**。

Practice 2

> Their swords clashed.

他們的劍互相**撞擊，發出金屬碰撞聲**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clash = 硬物互相猛烈碰撞並發出響亮尖銳的聲音****

32. **clash of metal — 金屬碰撞聲**

Practice 1

> We heard the **clash of metal**.

我們聽見**金屬碰撞的鏗鏘聲**。

Practice 2

> The clash of tools echoed through the workshop.

工具的**碰撞聲**在工場內迴響。

33. **clash of swords — 刀劍碰撞聲 / 刀劍交鋒**

Practice 1

> The **clash of swords** filled the hall.

大廳充滿了**刀劍交鋒的聲音**。

Practice 2

> The scene begins with the clash of swords.

場景以**刀劍相擊**開始。

34. **clash of cymbals — 銅鈸碰擊聲**

Practice 1

> The music ended with a loud **clash of cymbals**.

音樂以響亮的**銅鈸碰擊聲**結束。

Practice 2

> A sudden cymbal clash startled the audience.

突然的****鈹聲****令觀眾嚇了一跳。

35. ****metallic clash — 金屬鏗鏘碰撞聲****

Practice 1

> A loud ****metallic clash**** came from the workshop.

工場傳來一聲響亮的****金屬撞擊聲****。

Practice 2

> The door closed with a metallic clash.

門關上時發出一聲****鏗鏘的金屬聲****。

L. CLASH = COLOURS / STYLES DO NOT MATCH

36. ****colours clash — 顏色不協調；撞色得刺眼****

A major everyday sense.

Practice 1

> The red and purple ****clash**** badly.

紅色和紫色搭配起來非常****不協調****。

Practice 2

> These colours clash with each other.

這些顏色互相****不搭配****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****colours clash = 顏色放在一起時視覺上不協調或過度衝突****

37. ****clash with a colour — 與某顏色不搭****

Practice 1

> The tie **clashes** with the shirt.

領帶和襯衫的顏色**不搭**。

Practice 2

> Bright green may clash with the rest of the room.

鮮綠色可能與房間其他部分**不協調**。

38. **clashing colours** — 不協調 / 強烈衝突的顏色

Practice 1

> The room was decorated in **clashing colours**.

房間用了互相**不協調的顏色**裝飾。

Practice 2

> Some designers deliberately use clashing colours for dramatic effect.

有些設計師會刻意使用**強烈撞色**來製造戲劇效果。

Important: **clashing colours** can be negative or deliberately artistic.

39. **patterns clash** — 圖案不搭

Practice 1

> The two patterns **clash**.

這兩種圖案**不搭**。

Practice 2

> Stripes and large floral prints can clash if combined carelessly.

條紋和大型花卉圖案如果配搭不當，可能會**互相衝突**。

40. **styles clash** — 風格不協調

Practice 1

> The modern furniture **clashes with the traditional interior**.

現代家具與傳統室內設計**風格不協調**。

Practice 2

> Their design styles **clash**.

他們的設計風格**互不協調**。

M. CLASH = DATES / EVENTS OVERLAP

41. **events clash** — 活動時間相撞

A very important BrE/workplace sense.

Practice 1

> The two meetings **clash**.

兩個會議**時間相撞**。

Practice 2

> My appointment **clashes with the training session**.

我的預約與培訓課程**時間衝突**。

MCQ-ready definition:

events clash = 兩件事安排在相同或重疊時間，因此無法同時參加

42. **date clash** — 日期衝突

Practice 1

> There is a **date clash** between the conference and the workshop.

研討會和工作坊之間有**日期衝突**。

Practice 2

> We changed the launch date to avoid a clash.

我們更改推出日期，以避免**時間衝突**。

43. **scheduling clash — 日程衝突**

Practice 1

> A **scheduling clash** prevented her from attending.

日程衝突令她無法出席。

Practice 2

> The system warns users about scheduling clashes.

系統會提醒使用者有**時間表衝突**。

44. **appointment clash — 預約時間衝突**

Practice 1

> I have an **appointment clash** on Friday afternoon.

我星期五下午有**預約時間衝突**。

Practice 2

> Could we move the meeting? It clashes with another appointment.

可以改會議時間嗎？它和另一個預約**撞時間**。

45. **fixture clash — 賽事時間衝突**

Especially BrE sports.

Practice 1

> A **fixture clash** forced the match to be rescheduled.

賽程衝突令比賽需要改期。

Practice 2

> The club faced a fixture clash with another competition.

球會遇到與另一項賽事的**賽期衝突**。

N. CLASH = RULES / REQUIREMENTS ARE INCOMPATIBLE

46. **rules clash** — 規則互相衝突

Practice 1

> Local rules may **clash with company policy**.

本地規則可能與公司政策**互相抵觸**。

Practice 2

> The two requirements clash.

兩項要求**互相矛盾 / 無法同時滿足**。

47. **clash with a policy/law** — 與政策 / 法律抵觸

Practice 1

> The proposal **clashes with existing policy**.

方案與現有政策**互相抵觸**。

Practice 2

> Some internal procedures may clash with legal requirements.

某些內部程序可能與法律要求**發生衝突**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clash with X = 與 X 不相容，不能順利同時存在或遵守****

48. ****principles clash — 原則互相衝突****

Practice 1

> Two important principles ****clash in this case****.

在這宗個案中，兩項重要原則****互相衝突****。

Practice 2

> Individual freedom may sometimes clash with collective responsibility.

個人自由有時可能與集體責任****互相抵觸****。

O. CLASH = COMPETITION BETWEEN TEAMS / IMPORTANT ENCOUNTER

49. ****clash = sports match between important opponents — 對決；大戰****

Especially in sports journalism.

Practice 1

> The two teams meet in a crucial ****clash**** on Saturday.

兩隊星期六將進行一場關鍵****對決****。

Practice 2

> Fans are looking forward to the championship clash.

球迷期待這場錦標賽****大戰 / 對決****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clash = 尤其體育新聞中，兩個強勁或重要對手之間的一場比賽****

50. ****title clash — 冠軍爭奪戰****

Practice 1

> The teams meet in a major **title clash**.

兩隊將進行一場重要的**冠軍爭奪戰**。

Practice 2

> The title clash attracted a large audience.

這場**爭冠大戰**吸引大量觀眾。

51. **top-of-the-table clash — 榜首大戰**

Especially football/sports journalism.

Practice 1

> Sunday's match is a **top-of-the-table clash**.

星期日的比賽是一場**榜首大戰**。

Practice 2

> The clash could affect the championship standings.

這場**對決**可能影響錦標排名。

P. CLASH = FORCEFUL DIFFERENCE IN SOUND / SENSORY EFFECT

52. **sounds clash — 聲音不協調**

Practice 1

> The instruments **clashed unpleasantly**.

樂器聲音互相**不協調**，聽起來很刺耳。

Practice 2

> The two melodies clash in places.

兩段旋律在某些地方**不和諧**。

53. **clashing sounds — 刺耳 / 不和諧的聲音**

Practice 1

> The room was filled with **clashing sounds**.

房間充滿互相**衝突、不和諧的聲音**。

Practice 2

> The composer deliberately used clashing harmonies.

作曲家刻意使用**不和諧和聲**。

Q. AVOID / PREVENT / RESOLVE A CLASH

54. **avoid a clash — 避免衝突**

Practice 1

> The manager intervened early to **avoid a clash**.

經理及早介入以**避免衝突**。

Practice 2

> We changed the timetable to avoid a scheduling clash.

我們修改時間表以**避免日程衝突**。

55. **prevent a clash — 防止衝突**

Practice 1

> Clear roles can **prevent clashes between team members**.

清晰角色可以**防止團隊成員之間的衝突**。

Practice 2

> Police were deployed to prevent further clashes.

警方被部署以防止進一步**衝突**。

56. **resolve a clash — 解決衝突**

Practice 1

> Strong leadership can **resolve personality clashes**.

優秀領導可以**處理並化解性格衝突**。

Practice 2

> The departments met to resolve a clash of priorities.

各部門開會以**化解優先事項之間的衝突**。

57. **lead to a clash — 導致衝突**

Practice 1

> Different expectations can **lead to a clash**.

不同期望可能**導致衝突**。

Practice 2

> Poor communication led to repeated clashes.

溝通不良導致反覆**發生衝突**。

R. CLASHING

58. **clashing = incompatible or conflicting — 互相衝突的**

Practice 1

> The team had **clashing priorities**.

團隊有**互相衝突的優先事項**。

Practice 2

> Clashing personalities made cooperation difficult.

互不相容的性格令合作變得困難。

MCQ-ready definition:

clashing = 彼此不相容、互相衝突或不協調的

59. **clashing views — 互相衝突的觀點**

Practice 1

> The discussion exposed **clashing views** on risk.

討論暴露出大家對風險的**相反觀點**。

Practice 2

> Leaders should help reconcile clashing views.

領導者應協助調和**互相衝突的看法**。

60. **clashing demands — 互相衝突的要求**

Practice 1

> Managers often face **clashing demands**.

管理人員經常面對**彼此衝突的要求**。

Practice 2

> Speed and accuracy can become clashing demands.

速度和準確性有時會變成**互相抵觸的要求**。

Important distinction 1: **clash vs conflict**

conflict

the broadest term:

- * disagreement,
- * incompatibility,
- * struggle,
- * war.

clash

usually suggests a more **direct, noticeable collision** between:

- * people,
- * views,
- * personalities,
- * interests.

> workplace conflict

> 廣義職場衝突

> personality clash

> 具體性格不合 / 摩擦

A clash is often a type of conflict.

Important distinction 2: **clash vs disagreement**

disagreement

people think differently.

clash

the difference becomes active friction or confrontation.

> We disagreed about the plan.

> 我們意見不同。

> We clashed over the plan.

> 我們因計劃問題**發生衝突**。

Clash is stronger.

Important distinction 3: **clash** vs **argument**

argument

actual verbal disagreement.

clash

broader:

- * may be verbal,
- * personal,
- * institutional,
- * physical,
- * ideological.

Two departments can clash without one particular argument.

Important distinction 4: **clash** vs **quarrel**

quarrel

personal verbal dispute, often emotional.

clash

can be impersonal/professional.

> quarrel with a friend

> 與朋友吵架

> clash over strategic priorities

> 因策略優先事項而衝突

Important distinction 5: **clash** vs **fight**

fight

stronger and may mean:

- * physical violence,
- * intense argument.

clash

may remain a disagreement without a literal fight.

But **violent clashes** can include fighting.

Important distinction 6: **clash vs confrontation**

confrontation

direct face-to-face opposition.

clash

emphasizes incompatible forces/views actually colliding.

A clash may lead to confrontation.

Important distinction 7: **clash vs tension**

tension

strained atmosphere; conflict may not yet happen openly.

clash

actual expressed collision/disagreement.

Sequence can be:

> differences → tension → clash.

This is especially relevant to your passage.

Important distinction 8: **clash vs friction**

friction

ongoing smaller interpersonal difficulty.

clash

often a more visible episode or stronger incompatibility.

> friction between colleagues

> 持續摩擦

> a clash during a meeting

> 一次明顯衝突

Important distinction 9: **clash vs dispute**

dispute

formal/extended disagreement about a particular issue.

clash

can be shorter, more emotional or more direct.

> contractual dispute

> 合約爭議

> personality clash

> 性格衝突

Important distinction 10: **clash vs contest**

From your previous word.

contest

competition to prevail/win.

clash

collision between incompatible people/positions.

> contest of egos

> 自我較量

> personality clash

> 性格不合

A contest emphasizes ****winning****; a clash emphasizes ****incompatibility/conflict****.

Important distinction 11: ****clash vs collide****

****collide****

literal objects/vehicles strike each other; figuratively ideas may collide.

****clash****

physical sound collision or figurative disagreement.

For vehicles:

> two cars collided 

> two cars clashed  normally unnatural

For people/views:

> their views clashed 

Important distinction 12: ****clash vs crash****

****crash****

violent collision, especially vehicles/aircraft, usually causing damage.

****clash****

hard objects strike with a metallic/noisy effect, or people/groups conflict.

> cars crash

> swords clash

Do not interchange them.

Important distinction 13: **clash vs bang**

bang

one loud impact/noise.

clash

often two hard/metallic objects striking together.

> door banged shut

> 門砰一聲關上

> swords clashed

> 刀劍鏗鏘相擊

Important distinction 14: **clash vs clang**

clang

specifically loud resonant metallic sound.

clash

collision plus sound; broader.

> cymbals clash

> metal clangs

They can overlap.

Important distinction 15: **personality clash vs personality difference**

personality difference

neutral:

people have different personalities.

personality clash

those differences actually cause friction.

Different ≠ clashing.

Important distinction 16: **personality clash vs contest of egos**

From your earlier sentence:

personality clash

incompatible temperaments/styles.

contest of egos

people compete to protect superiority/status.

A personality clash may exist without ego competition.

An ego contest can happen even between people with otherwise similar personalities.

Important distinction 17: **clash of views vs contest of ideas**

clash of views

views are incompatible and conflict.

contest of ideas

ideas compete to be accepted as better.

Again:

> clash → incompatibility

> contest → competition.

Important distinction 18: **clash of interests vs conflict of interest**

Critical distinction repeated because learners easily confuse these:

clash of interests

A and B want incompatible outcomes.

conflict of interest

one person has competing duties/personal interests that may compromise impartiality.

Not synonyms.

Important distinction 19: **clash of priorities vs differing priorities**

differing priorities

simply not the same.

clashing priorities

cannot easily be satisfied together.

Example:

> speed + caution can differ

> but become a **clash** when one side demands launch today and the other refuses approval.

Important distinction 20: **clash with vs contradict**

clash with

be incompatible with.

contradict

directly state or logically imply the opposite.

> schedule clashes with another event

> 時間衝突

> statement contradicts the evidence

> 說法與證據矛盾

Not all clashes are logical contradictions.

Important distinction 21: **clash with vs conflict with**

Very close.

conflict with

more neutral/formal, especially:

- * rules,
- * requirements,
- * obligations.

clash with

more vivid.

- > clause conflicts with the law
- > 條款與法律衝突

- > policy clashes with company values
- > 政策與公司價值觀強烈抵觸

Important distinction 22: **clash = colour mismatch vs contrast**

contrast

differences can look attractive or deliberate.

clash

differences look unpleasant/incompatible.

- > black and white contrast
- > 黑白對比

- > orange and purple clash
- > 橙紫配搭不協調

But deliberate **clashing colours** can be fashionable.

Important distinction 23: **clash vs mismatch**

mismatch

things do not fit/match well.

clash

stronger visual or conceptual conflict.

> mismatched socks

> 不成對襪子

> clashing colours

> 刺眼撞色

Important distinction 24: **clash = schedule vs overlap**

overlap

times share part of the same period.

clash

overlap causes a practical problem because you cannot attend/do both.

> The meetings overlap by ten minutes.

> 兩個會議重疊十分鐘。

> The meetings clash.

> 兩個會議**撞時間，無法同時參加**。

Excellent distinction.

Important distinction 25: **clash vs coincide**

coincide

occur at the same time; neutral.

clash

same timing causes incompatibility.

> The festivals coincide this year.

> 兩個節慶今年同時舉行。

> My exams clash.

> 我的考試**時間相撞**。

Important distinction 26: **clash vs conflict in scheduling**

Both work:

> scheduling conflict

> 日程衝突

> scheduling clash

> 日程衝突

Clash is especially natural in BrE.

Important distinction 27: **sports clash vs contest**

clash

sports journalism often suggests exciting/high-profile opponents.

contest

emphasizes competitive struggle.

> Liverpool–Arsenal clash

> 兩支強隊的對決

> a close contest

> 勢均力敵的比賽

Important distinction 28: **clashing colours can be deliberate**

****Clash**** normally implies lack of harmony.

But fashion/art may intentionally use:

> bold clashing colours

for strong visual effect.

So ****clashing**** does not always equal “bad design.”

Important distinction 29: ****violent clash vs war****

****clash****

can refer to a limited episode of violence.

****war****

large-scale sustained armed conflict.

A border clash does not automatically mean war.

Important distinction 30: ****clash in your passage****

The paragraph says:

> personality ****clashes**** need not destroy cooperation.

The writer is not saying:

> personalities are merely different.

The stronger meaning is:

****those differences actively create tension or conflict****

But:

> need not destroy cooperation

signals that these clashes can be managed through:

- * respectful leadership,
- * conflict resolution,
- * emotional intelligence,
- * directing disagreement toward ideas rather than people.

Family-extension note

The **clash** family has several major modern branches:

1. **interpersonal conflict**

- * clash with someone
- * clash over something

2. **personality conflict**

- * personality clash
- * clash of personalities

3. **opinion conflict**

- * views clash
- * clash of opinions

4. **values/interests**

- * clash of values
- * clash of interests

5. **priorities/goals**

- * priorities clash
- * clashing objectives

6. **culture/generations**

- * cultural clash
- * generational clash

7. **violent confrontation**

- * clash with police
- * armed clash

* border clash

8. **physical noisy collision**

* swords clash

* clash of cymbals

9. **visual incompatibility**

* colours clash

* clashing patterns

10. **scheduling conflict**

* meetings clash

* date clash

* fixture clash

11. **rules/requirements**

* clash with policy

* principles clash

12. **sports encounter**

* major clash

* title clash

13. **adjective/participle**

* clashing views

* clashing demands

For your passage, the exact branch is:

clash = active interpersonal friction caused by incompatible personalities or working styles

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
clash (people)	衝突；不和	interpersonal conflict
clash with someone	與某人發生衝突	conflict
clash over X	因 X 發生衝突	issue-based conflict

clash on/about X	就 X 意見衝突	disagreement	
personality clash	性格衝突	passage sense	
clash of personalities	性格不合	personality	
personalities clash	性格互不相容	friction	
clash of opinions	意見衝突	views	
views clash	觀點互相衝突	views	
clash of views	觀點衝突	views	
values clash	價值觀衝突	values	
clash of values	價值觀衝突	values	
interests clash	利益衝突	interests	
clash of interests	利益衝突	incompatible interests	
priorities clash	優先事項衝突	priorities	
clash of priorities	優先事項衝突	priorities	
goals clash	目標衝突	goals	
clashing objectives	互相衝突的目標	objectives	
cultural clash	文化衝突	culture	
generational clash	世代衝突	generations	
clash (violent)	衝突事件	confrontation	
clash with police	與警方衝突	confrontation	
violent clash	暴力衝突	violence	
armed clash	武裝衝突	armed conflict	
border clash	邊境衝突	border	
street clashes	街頭衝突	unrest	
clash (sound)	碰撞並發出鏗鏘聲	physical sound	
clash of metal	金屬碰撞聲	sound	
clash of swords	刀劍交鋒	physical collision	
clash of cymbals	銅鈸碰擊聲	music	
colours clash	顏色不協調	visual	
clashing colours	強烈撞色 / 不協調色	visual	
patterns clash	圖案不搭	visual	
styles clash	風格不協調	design	
events clash	活動時間相撞	schedule	
date clash	日期衝突	scheduling	
scheduling clash	日程衝突	scheduling	
appointment clash	預約時間衝突	scheduling	
fixture clash	賽程衝突	sports schedule	
rules clash	規則衝突	incompatibility	
clash with policy	與政策抵觸	rules	
principles clash	原則衝突	principles	
sports clash	體育對決	match	
title clash	冠軍爭奪戰	sports	
clashing sounds	不和諧聲音	sensory	
avoid a clash	避免衝突	prevention	
prevent a clash	防止衝突	prevention	
resolve a clash	解決衝突	resolution	
clashing views	相互衝突的觀點	adjective	

| **clashing demands** | 相互衝突的要求 | incompatibility |

For your original sentence

> Nevertheless, personality **clashes** need not destroy cooperation.

Here:

personality clashes = 團隊成員因性格、溝通方式、工作節奏或處理壓力的方法不相容，而產生持續摩擦或明顯衝突

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 然而，**性格衝突 / 個性不合**並不一定會破壞合作。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

- > **difference** = 只是不同
- > **disagreement** = 意見不同
- > **friction** = 持續的小摩擦
- > **tension** = 緊張氣氛
- > **clash** = **兩種不相容的人、立場或做法正面碰撞**
- > **conflict** = 最廣泛的衝突概念
- > **contest** = 互相競爭，看誰勝出

And in this paragraph specifically:

- > **direct vs cautious** = personality/style difference
- > if poorly managed → **personality clash**
- > repeated clash → **tension**
- > tension → weaker **trust**
- > weaker trust → professionally **damaging** teamwork

So **clash** is the point where mere difference becomes **active friction**.